Negative Double

Partner opens 1 of a suit and the next opponent overcalls a suit:
Double by you is not for penalty - it says you **would** have responded if no overcall.
You need 6+ points for 1-level double, more for higher level double
Negative Double promises at least four cards in any unbid Major
If both Majors have been bid, double promises both minors
1♣/♦ - 1♥ - dbl - promises 4-card Spade suit
1♣/♦ - 1♥ - 1♠ - promises 5+ card Spade suit

Support Cue-bid

When partner opens and next player overcalls, a Cue-bid by you shows Limit-raise or better support for partner's suit. Any raise of partner's suit is preemptive and shows LESS than a Limit-raise.

When an opponent opens, partner overcalls, and the next opponent passes, a Cue-bid by you shows Limit-raise or better support for partner's suit. Any raise of partner's suit is preemptive and shows LESS than a Limit-raise.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦3

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 2♣
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣5

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 2♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♥K

Board: 4
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣5

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ 9 ♥ K Q J 7 ♦ A K 6 ♣ A Q 10 5 4	
♠ K 5 4 2 ♥ 8 5 ♦ J 10 7 5 ♣ J 9 8		♠ A Q J 7 3 ♥ 10 3 ♦ Q 9 3 2 ♣ 7 3
	♠ 10 8 6 ♥ A 9 6 4 2 ♦ 8 4 ♣ K 6 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♣	1♠	Dbl
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by North
Lead: ♦3

SOUTH would have responded 1♥ if EAST had not overcalled. But with only 8 points he cannot bid at the 2-level. The Negative Double solves his problem, giving this information to partner.

NORTH has good ♥s and enough points to bid game. Notice that if EAST had remained silent, SOUTH would have responded 1♥, and NORTH would have jumped to game.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ J 5 4 ♥ Q 6 5 2 ♦ Q 10 8 3 ♣ A 3	
♠ A K 6 2 ♥ 9 3 ♦ 9 7 2 ♣ Q 9 8 2		♠ 10 9 7 ♥ K 8 7 ♦ A K 6 ♣ K J 10 4
	♠ Q 8 3 ♥ A J 10 4 ♦ J 5 4 ♣ 7 6 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♣	1♥
Dbl	Pass	1NT	Pass
2♣			
All Pass			

2♣ by East
Lead: ♣5

WEST has four ♠s, so instead of bidding them she makes a Negative Double.

EAST knows there is no 8-card fit in ♠s, but he does have ♥s stopped. He bids 1NT.

WEST has 9 points and with four ♣s she goes back to that suit and EAST passes.

Board 3
North Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ Q 9 7 ♥ J 8 7 ♦ A K 6 ♣ K J 10 4	
♠ J 8 4 ♥ A K 10 6 ♦ J 4 3 ♣ A 7 6		♠ 10 5 ♥ Q 5 4 2 ♦ Q 10 8 5 ♣ 8 5 3
	♠ A K 6 3 2 ♥ 9 3 ♦ 9 7 2 ♣ Q 9 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♣	1♥	1♠
Pass	2♠		
All Pass			

2♠ by South
Lead: ♥K

Compare this hand with Deal 6. SOUTH has five ♠s, this time so she bids 1♠.

NORTH knows there IS an 8-card fit in ♠s, so he bids 2♠.

SOUTH has 10 points so she passes.

Board 4
South Deals
Both Vul

♠ Q 10 4 3
♥ J 2
♦ A J 5 4
♣ Q 6 5

♠ A 5 2
♥ A Q 10 9 3
♦ 9 7
♣ A J 2



♠ 9 7
♥ K 8 7 4
♦ K Q 6
♣ K 10 9 4

♠ K J 8 6
♥ 6 5
♦ 10 8 3 2
♣ 8 7 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			Pass
1♥	1♠	2♠	Pass
4♥			
All Pass			

4♥ by West
Lead: ♣5

EAST has 11/12 points, a Limit Raise in ♥s. So after the overcall he makes a Support Cue-bid of 2♠.

WEST adds her 16 to the 11 that EAST has promised as a minimum and goes straight to 4♥.

If EAST had significantly more than 11 he could bid on, but in this case he should happily pass.